

5.5.3 Infrared

Infrared is a region of the electromagnetic spectrum whose frequency is longer than that of visible light. Infrared is used in portable devices as a means of transferring data wirelessly. This might seem like Bluetooth and Wi-Fi, but has several disadvantages—it is line-of-sight (the two devices may not be separated by obstacles like walls), has a low data transfer rate, and is shorter-ranged. Some mobile phones as well as wireless keyboard and mice used to come with infrared ports; these have been replaced with Bluetooth and / or Wi-Fi.

5.5.4 PictBridge

A camera industry standard. It uses USB and cables to transfer data to a printer from a camera without having to connect to a computer in between, so a picture can be directly printed. Most new cameras and printers support PictBridge.



The PictBridge logo

5.5.6 Ultra Wideband

A radio technology used for short-range, high-bandwidth (larger than 500 MHz) communications. It consumes very low energy and is suitable for applications like wirelessly transferring media from camcorders or high-speed printers.

5.5.7 USB

Universal Serial Bus is an almost ubiquitous standard for connecting devices like mice, keyboard, joysticks, printers, scanners, card readers, etc. to computers without switching off the system. USB comes in two versions—1.1 and 2.0, while a 3.0 standard is under development. These standards are based on speed. USB 1.1 transfers data at 1.5 to 12 Megabits per second, while USB 2.0 transfers data at 480 Megabits per second. USB 3.0 is projected to transfer data at a maximum rate of 4.8 Gigabits per second. A computer can connect to a maximum of 127 USB devices directly or by using hubs.